

CHENAB NAVALKHA

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EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA

Expected defense: May 2026

PhD, Urban Planning and Political Economy

Dissertation: *Shifting Terrains of Struggle: Tenant Organizing and the Politics of Housing Finance*

Committee: Karilyn Crockett, PhD (chair); Jason Jackson, PhD; Justin Steil, JD, PhD

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA

2021

Master in City Planning

Thesis: *Data for Housing Justice: Examining Activists' Use of Open Government Data in Boston, MA and New York, NY*

University of Chicago, Chicago, IL

2013

Bachelor of Arts in Philosophy; Bachelor of Arts in Biology (Neuroscience concentration)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Political economy of urban development, financialization, digitalization, urban governance, health and human environments, social movements

AWARDS AND GRANTS

- 2025 Sagalyn-Hack Dissertation Research Award, Department of Urban Studies & Planning, MIT
- 2024 Racially Just Research Initiative Microgrant, Department of Urban Studies & Planning, MIT
- 2024 Emerson Student Travel Award, Department of Urban Studies & Planning, MIT
- 2024 Kaufmann Teaching Certificate, Massachusetts Institute of Technology
- 2022 New York University Cities Collaborative-Mellon Summer Institute on Urbanism Fellowship
- 2022 Harold Horowitz (1951) Student Research Fund, School of Architecture & Planning
- 2021 Presidential Fellowship, Massachusetts Institute of Technology

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles

- 2025 So, Wonyoung, Asya Aizman, **Chenab Navalkha**, Catherine D'Ignazio. "Housing Data Politics in the United States: Inequitable Open Data, Informal Networks, and Strategic Neutrality in the Pursuit of Justice." *Journal of Urban Affairs*, 1-19. <https://doi.org/10.1080/07352166.2025.2554754>
- 2022 Sobecki, Janelle, Emily Abramsohn, Alexes Hazen, Jennifer Makelarski, **Chenab Navalkha**, Kristen Wroblewski, and Stacy T. Lindau. "The PRoBe-SH: A Close-Coded Patient-Reported Survey Tool to Assess Breast Surgery History: PRoBe-SH: patient-reported survey tool." *Archives of Breast Cancer*, 505-511. <https://doi.org/10.32768/abc.202294505-511>

- 2020 Abramsohn, Emily, Megan DePumpo, Kelly Boyd, Tiffany Brown, Milton F. Garrett, Abel Kho, **Chenab Navalkha**, Kelsey Paradise, and Stacy T. Lindau. "Implementation of community-based resource referrals for cardiovascular disease self-management." *The Annals of Family Medicine* 18, no. 6: 486-495. <https://doi.org/10.1370/afm.2583>
- 2020 Makelarski, Jennifer A., Megan DePumpo, Kelly Boyd, Tiffany Brown, Abel Kho, **Chenab Navalkha**, and Stacy T. Lindau. "Implementation of systematic community resource referrals at small primary care practices to promote cardiovascular disease self-management." *The Journal for Healthcare Quality (JHQ)* 42, no. 5: 278-286. <https://doi.org/10.1097/jhq.0000000000000234>
- 2019 Weiner, Dana, **Chenab Navalkha**, Emily Abramsohn, Megan DePumpo, Kelsey Paradise, Michael Stiehl, and Stacy Tessler Lindau. "Mobile resource referral technology for preventive child welfare services: Implementation and feasibility." *Children and Youth Services Review* 107: 104499. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chilyouth.2019.104499>
- 2019 Lees, Brittany F., Janelle Sobecki-Rausch, Taylor P. Stewart, Kaitlin M. Woo, **Chenab Navalkha**, Kelly Boyd, Stacy Tessler Lindau, and David M. Kushner. "Abuse history and sexual function among female cancer survivors attending a specialized sexual health clinic." *Gynecologic Oncology* 154: 19. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ygyno.2019.04.048>

Under Review and In Progress

"Left at the Altar of Development: A Counter-History of Black Grassroots Planning in Washington Park, Chicago." Submitted to *Journal of Planning History* August 1, 2025.

"From 'Captive Market' to Political Class: Tenant Subjectivation in the Era of Financialized Housing." (Dissertation Paper, to be submitted to *Housing Studies*; October 2025 expected submission).

Book Chapters

- 2025 Aizman, Asya, Wonyoung So, **Chenab Navalkha**, Catherine D'Ignazio. "Inequitable Openness, Informal Networks, and Strategic Neutrality of Housing Data." In *The Data Politics of Property and Planning*, ed. Danielle Hynes, Rob Kitchin, and Samuel Mutter (Bristol University Press). Forthcoming.
- 2021 Ndubuisi-Obi Jr, Innocent, Ziyu Ran, Yanchao Li, **Chenab Ahuja Navalkha**, Sarah Williams, and Lily Tsai. "Using public-private data to understand compliance with mobility restrictions in Sierra Leone." In *Urban Informatics and Future Cities*, ed. S.C.M. Geertman, Christopher Pettit, Robert Goodspeed, Aija Staffans (Springer Nature), 33-49. https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-3-030-76059-5_3

Other publications (selected)

- 2020 Robustelli, Tim, Yuliya Panfil, Katie Oran, **Chenab Navalkha**, and Emily Yelverton. "Displaced in America: Mapping housing loss across the United States." *New America*. <https://www.newamerica.org/future-property-rights/reports/displaced-america/>
- 2020 **Navalkha, Chenab**, Cassandra Robertson, Nikki Zeichner. "Pandemic Homelessness Could Leave Millions Unable to Access Benefits." *New America Weekly*. <https://www.newamerica.org/weekly/pandemic-homelessness-could-leave-millions-unable-access-public-benefits/>

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2025 “Democratizing Policy Expertise: Tenant Organizing for Economic Justice in the Neoliberal Era.” Society for the Advancement of Socio-economics Annual Meeting, Montreal, QC, Canada, July 9-12
- 2024 “Alternative Visions of Housing Policy in a National Tenant Campaign.” American Collegiate Society of Planners (ACSP) Annual Meeting, Seattle, WA, November 7-9
- 2024 “Against ‘Empty’ Space: Countering Media Representations of Black Placelessness in Washington Park, Chicago.” Society of City and Regional Planning History, San Diego, CA, October 2024
- 2024 “The Varied Landscape of Housing Data Politics.” With co-authors Wonyoung So, Asya Aizman, and Catherine D’Ignazio. Data Politics of Housing & Planning Workshop, Maynooth University, Maynooth, Ireland, September 2-3
- 2024 “Against ‘Empty’ Space: Countering Media Representations of Black Placelessness in Washington Park, Chicago.” Rethinking the Media-Gentrification Nexus Workshop, Boston University, Boston, MA, June 10
- 2024 “New Challenges to Racial Equity: The Rise of Digital Platforms in Housing Markets,” with Jason Jackson. PROJECT REACH Financial Inclusion Summit, Washington, DC, May 29-30
- 2018 “Implementation of Technology for Community Referral Services.” With Dana Weiner. MetroLab Network Summit, Newark, NJ, October 15-16

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

At Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Department of Urban Studies and Planning, Cambridge, MA

Teaching Development Fellow

- 2024- 2025 Led trainings on evidence-based teaching and learning strategies for doctoral teaching assistants; created resource for first-time teaching assistants on how to approach varied aspects of teaching (e.g. active learning strategies, grading and assessment, feedback).

Doctoral Teaching Assistant

Spring 2025	Microeconomics Graduate level course for urban planning students; Evaluations: 7.0/7.0
Spring 2025	Planning Economics Graduate level course for urban planning students; Evaluations: 6.3/7.0
Fall 2024; Fall 2022	Gateway I: Introduction to the History and Theory of Urban Planning Graduate level; Evaluation: 6.5/7 (Fall 2024), 6.2/7 (Fall 2022)
Spring 2024	Quantitative Reasoning and Statistical Methods for Planning Graduate level; Evaluations: 6.8/7.0

Spring 2024	Introduction to Critical Qualitative Methods Graduate level; Evaluations: 6.9/7.0
Spring 2023	Gateway II: Planning Skills & Techniques Graduate level course for urban planning students; Evaluations: 6.5/7.0

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

At Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA

- 2023-2024 **Research Assistant, Professor Karilyn Crockett (Urban Studies and Planning)**
Focus: “Hacking the Archive,” co-designing archives of activist histories and stories in the Boston area with students, activists, and residents.
- 2021-2023 **Research Assistant, Healthy Neighborhoods Study**
Focus: Participatory Action Research (PAR) analysis of changes in property ownership in Boston-area neighborhoods to answer resident research questions
- 2019-2021 **Research Assistant, Civic Data Design Lab, Professor Sarah Williams**
Focus: Examining compliance with mobility restriction policies during COVID-19 in Sierra Leone (partnership with MIT GOV/LAB)

External

- 2015-2019 **Special Projects Research Team Lead & Project Manager, Lindau Laboratory, Biological Sciences Division, University of Chicago, Chicago, IL**
Social science research lab working in the domains of public and community health and women’s health. Conducted research in two areas: (1) design and evaluation of informational social care interventions delivered in the clinical setting to connect patients to community resources; (2) research and patient education for women recovering from cancer and cancer treatment.

Select activities:

- Trained and supervised junior research assistants in research protocol development and dissemination activities including: literature reviews and synthesis, Institutional Review Board (IRB) protocol development, data visualization and research dissemination for urban health research
- Conducted qualitative analysis, collaboratively developed novel survey instrument to systematically assess breast surgery history in the clinical setting; led and collaborated on manuscript development
- Managed development and submission of 3 grant proposals to internal funding opportunities and to the National Institutes of Health (R01 proposal to National Institutes of Minority Health and Health Disparities funded June 2019; R21 proposal to National Cancer Institute funded March 2019)

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- 2023- Co-editor, Volume 18: Planning in and for Polycrisis, *Projections: Journal of the MIT Department of Urban Studies & Planning*, 2024-2025
- 2019- Mentor, Peer Application Support Services (PASS), MIT Department of Urban Studies & Planning,

2020-2021 Co-leader, Students of Color Committee, MIT Department of Urban Studies & Planning,
2020-2021 Graduate Student Representative, MIT School of Architecture and Planning Search
Committee: Assistant Dean of Diversity, 2020-2021
2015-2018 Advisory Board Member, University Community Service Center, University of Chicago

Memberships in Professional Associations and Networks

American Society of City Planners (ACSP)
Urban Affairs Association (UAA)
Society for American Regional and City Planning History (SARCPH)
Society for the Advancement of Socio-economics (SASE)
American Association of Geographers (AAG)

SELECT PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2021 Homes Guarantee

Research Analyst, National Tenant Bill of Rights Campaign

2020 New America

Graduate Student Intern, Future of Land and Housing Program

2020 Berkman Klein Center for Internet and Society, Harvard University

Summer Fellow, AI Policy

REFERENCES

Karilyn Crockett, Assistant Professor of Urban History, Public Policy & Planning
Department of Urban Studies and Planning, Massachusetts Institute of Technology
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Justin Steil, Associate Professor of Law and Urban Planning
Department of Urban Studies and Planning, Massachusetts Institute of Technology
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Jason Jackson, Associate Professor of Political Economy and Urban Planning
Department of Urban Studies and Planning, Massachusetts Institute of Technology
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